IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 28, 2026

Selective Records

S&P 500 and Nasdaq notch fresh closes as semiconductor leadership narrows to NVDA into the FOMC and the heaviest hyperscaler print sequence of the quarter.

S&P 500	NVDA	BRENT (BNO PROXY)	BITCOIN (IBIT)	FEAR & GREED
~7,152 ↑0.17%	$216.61 ↑4.00%	↑1.84% · Firming	$43.56 ↓1.04%	33 · Fear

SECTION 01

Markets

RECORDS ON NARROWING LEADERSHIP — NVDA CARRIES THE TAPE WHILE THE REST OF THE SEMICONDUCTOR SLEEVE SELLS OFF

The S&P 500 added 0.17% to roughly 7,152 and the Nasdaq advanced 0.05% to a marginally higher close, both above Friday's record print, but the headline conceals a notable dispersion inside IOWN's growth sleeve. NVDA gained 4.00% to a new all-time high of $216.61, while AMD fell 3.79% to $334.63 on a Northland Capital Markets downgrade, CRDO dropped 7.45% to $180.50, MRVL declined 3.71%, NXPI lost 2.94%, KEYS fell 1.82%, and LRCX retraced 3.10%. The capex narrative that lifted the entire chip complex on Friday is now resolving into specific names ahead of Wednesday's hyperscaler prints. Financials led at +0.76% as TLT eased 0.50%, while staples (−1.07%), real estate (−0.78%) and discretionary (−0.72%) lagged on the modest backup in yields. UVXY compressed 4.68% — volatility positioning is tightening into the catalyst stack, not unwinding it.

QCOM REVERSES AN INTRADAY SURGE ON THE OPENAI HEADLINE — INTRADAY RANGE $147.05–$161.00 BEFORE SETTLING AT $150.26

QCOM traded a $13.95 intraday range Monday after Ming-Chi Kuo flagged a reported collaboration with OpenAI and MediaTek to build custom AI smartphone chips for a 2028 production window, per Yahoo Finance and Schaeffer's coverage. The stock opened at $156.31, printed a high of $161.00, then faded to a low of $147.05 before closing at $150.26 (+0.95%). The price action validates the AI-edge optionality thesis the SeekingAlpha Q2 preview identified as the central QCOM earnings narrative, but the intraday reversal into Wednesday's after-close report indicates positioning is now stretched. Seeking Alpha downgraded the name on the move, citing a profit-taking opportunity. The committee should weigh the reported partnership against the structural Apple modem-insourcing risk that anchors the Barclays Underweight thesis — the OpenAI relationship lengthens the optionality runway but does not resolve the 2027 royalty cliff.

FOMC CONVENES TODAY — FIVE IOWN NAMES REPORT TONIGHT INTO THE FIRST DAY OF THE MEETING

The FOMC begins its two-day meeting today with the decision and Powell press conference Wednesday at 2:00 PM ET. CME FedWatch implies a hold with effectively no probability of a move, and JPMorgan Research and Morgan Stanley both sit at hold-through-2026 on the rate path. Five IOWN names report today: EIX, HOOD, PCAR, NXPI, and OKE — a dense print sequence that spans utilities, capital markets, heavy trucks, semiconductors, and midstream energy. PCAR consensus is $1.17 per share with the Seekin-

gAlpha preview flagging a probable beat against muted Class 8 truck demand, while NXPI consensus sits at $3.01 on revenue near $3.14B. OKE's commentary on Permian gathering volumes will carry read-across to CTRA and CVX. The Powell-to-Warsh succession will be the press-conference subtext on Wednesday, with the DOJ probe now closed and the Senate confirmation track open ahead of the May 15 term expiry.

S&P 500	~7,152 · ↑0.17% · Above Friday's record close
NVDA / AMD	NVDA ↑4.00% ATH · AMD ↓3.79% Northland downgrade
BOTTOM MOVERS	CRDO ↓7.45% · MRVL ↓3.71% · NXPI ↓2.94%
QCOM RANGE	$147.05–$161.00 · Closed $150.26 (+0.95%)
FOMC	Day 1 today · Decision Wed 2 PM ET · Hold priced
IOWN EARNINGS	EIX · HOOD · PCAR · NXPI · OKE today

A tape that prints fresh records while the bulk of the chip sleeve sells off is communicating that capex faith is being repriced into individual names. Wednesday's hyperscaler prints will define which AI-infrastructure positions survive this rotation. **Research Reveals Opportunities.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics

IRAN'S HORMUZ-FIRST PROPOSAL REACHES THE WHITE HOUSE — TRUMP SIGNALED REJECTION ON MONDAY

Iran delivered a new proposal Monday through Pakistani channels offering to reopen the Strait of Hormuz and end the war in exchange for the lifting of the US naval blockade, with formal nuclear negotiations postponed to a later stage, per Washington Post, Axios, and PBS NewsHour reporting. President Trump and his national security team reviewed the framework with Secretary Rubio and senior advisors, after which the planned Kushner-Witkoff trip to Pakistan was cancelled. CNN sources indicated Trump is unlikely to accept the proposal as structured, and Rubio publicly stated that any framework that defers the nuclear question is unacceptable. The structural impasse from prior briefs persists: Iran insists the blockade be lifted before substantive nuclear talks resume; the US insists on a sequenced deal that addresses enrichment alongside the maritime de-escalation. The conflict has now entered its tenth week, and the IEA continues to characterize the disruption as the largest energy supply shock on record.

OIL FIRMED 2% AS THE DIPLOMATIC TRACK STALLED — REFINING MARGINS HOLD THE IOWN ENERGY THESIS

USO rose 1.75% Monday and BNO advanced 1.84% as the Iran proposal failed to clear, with both crude benchmarks firming on the absence of a near-term diplomatic off-ramp per CNBC and Reuters coverage. The energy sleeve mostly held: VLO advanced 1.02% to $238.25, OKE edged up 0.29% ahead of tonight's print, and CTRA gained 0.42%, while CVX softened 0.23%. Gold compressed 0.78% to a three-week low as risk capital rotated toward duration-sensitive equity, an unusual signal at this stage of the cycle. Morgan Stanley reiterated that refining margins are unlikely to return to pre-conflict levels in the near term, supporting the structural revenue case for VLO. BP's Q1 reported profit more than doubled to $3.2B per Reuters — concrete evidence that the integrated energy complex is monetizing the dislocation.

IRAN PROPOSAL	Hormuz-first · Nuclear deferred · Trump unlikely to accept (CNN)
KUSHNER-WITKOFF	Pakistan trip cancelled · Talks back-channel only
OIL	USO ↑1.75% · BNO ↑1.84% · Both benchmarks firming
GOLD	GLD ↓0.78% · Three-week low
BP Q1	Profit doubled to $3.2B on war trading (Reuters)
CONFLICT DURATION	Week 10 · IEA — largest energy supply shock on record

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Five IOWN names report tonight, with NXPI and PCAR the most consequential for the sleeve. NXPI consensus is $3.01 per share on revenue near $3.14B, with auto and industrial end-market commentary the read-across to ADI, TEL, and the broader analog complex. PCAR consensus is $1.17 with the SeekingAlpha preview flagging the potential for an upside print despite muted Class 8 backlog. EIX and OKE round out the dividend-sleeve cohort, with EIX likely to address wildfire-liability disclosures and OKE positioned to provide the first read on Permian gathering volumes that informs CTRA and CVX exposure. HOOD's growth trajectory carries the cleanest read on retail engagement post-Q1 rebalance. The dispersion in the bottom five — CRDO, ATAT, MARA, AMD, MRVL — suggests positioning is being trimmed selectively into the print sequence rather than de-risked broadly. *Think Like an Owner.*

2. The Powell-Warsh transition is now the FOMC press-conference subtext. Wednesday's 2:00 PM ET decision is widely expected to deliver a hold, but the language around energy-inflation pass-through and the framing of the Powell succession will move the long end. TLT closed Monday at $86.28 (–0.50%) — the 20-year complex is already pricing modestly more hawkishness than the FOMC consensus. Any signal in the press conference that the May 15 leadership transition will tilt the committee toward a more restrictive posture would extend that move. The rate-sensitive dividend names — ATO, NEE, BKH, EIX — are positioned at the intersection of this risk and tonight's utility prints. *Avoid Erosion.*

3. The Mag7 capex deck arrives Wednesday after close — MSFT, GOOGL, META back-to-back. Microsoft consensus sits near $4.04 EPS on $81.4B revenue, with Azure growth the read-across to NVDA and the broader hyperscaler tape, per Yahoo Finance. Alphabet consensus is approximately $2.64 EPS on $92.2B revenue, with top-line growth tracking near 21% year-over-year. Meta's 2026 capital expenditure plan stepped up to $115B–$135B in the prior guidance cycle — the Q1 commentary on monetization of that spend will define whether the AI-tape multiple holds or compresses. Industry hyperscaler capex is now estimated above $320B for the four largest US cloud players in 2026 per CreditSights. The dispersion in IOWN's growth sleeve Monday foreshadows this catalyst — only NVDA was rewarded for the AI-infrastructure exposure ahead of the prints. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

4. Q1 advance GDP and March Personal Income & Outlays both print Thursday at 8:30 AM ET. The BEA release schedule confirms the Personal Income and Outlays release for April 30, 2026 — the March PCE component is the more market-relevant data point. The Atlanta Fed GDPNow nowcast and the New York Fed nowcast continue to bracket a wide Q1 range, suggesting material uncertainty in the advance print. An accelerating core PCE would harden the Fed's hold posture into the June meeting and reinforce the higher-for-longer commodity-inflation thesis underlying the energy sleeve. A softer print could re-open the late-2026 cut path that JPMorgan has already pushed beyond the year. The release is consequential for the duration-sensitive sub-sleeves and the long end of the curve. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

5. Bitcoin and ether ETFs drifted lower with the gold complex. IBIT closed at $43.56 (–1.04%) and ETHA at $17.27 (–1.43%), tracking the broader risk-asset compression that also hit precious metals as Iran's diplomatic proposal stalled. Spot Bitcoin ETF flows turned positive for the year per April data summarized by AInvest, and the structural-flow thesis behind IBIT and ETHA remains intact even as spot prices consolidate. The Hut 8 announcement of $3.25B in investment-grade senior secured notes for the River Bend Data Center project is the most consequential digital-infrastructure development in the sleeve, per Finnhub and Benzinga — the AI-power crossover thesis that anchors HUT, MARA, and CRDO continues to attract institutional debt capital. *The physical world matters.*

6. The Hormuz proposal's rejection narrows the diplomatic path. Trump's reported reluctance to accept Iran's framework, combined with the cancellation of the Kushner-Witkoff trip and Rubio's public statement on the centrality of the nuclear question, suggests the timeline toward a next escalation cycle could compress faster than the prior brief framed. Oil's 2% advance Monday is consistent with the market repricing tail risk into Brent and WTI. The IOWN energy sleeve — VLO, CVX, CTRA, OKE — carries the structural exposure, with refining margins still well above pre-conflict baselines per Morgan Stanley. A weekend escalation event — tanker seizure, kinetic action, or formal talks collapse — would gap oil higher and pressure the AI-tape multiple ahead of Friday's month-end rebalance flows. **Think Like an Owner.**

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